

Flexible displays and the world beyond 1080p

Qualitative tweaks in display technology this year

On mobile devices, the display is an essential part of the buying decision. How much pixel does it pack? Is it Super AMOLED? Gorilla Glass layer? No end to customer nitpicking. This year will see the introduction of some new technology that will both amaze and excite the user's perception of display screens.

One of the most anticipated trend in mobile phone screens is the introduction of flexible displays, ever since Nokia showcased a prototype device last year! One report suggests the display is made of carbon nanotubes whose electrical properties change when they're stretched, letting you zoom in and out. Nokia and Samsung will be among the first ones to launch a smartphone with flexible displays later this year.

Mobile phone displays will gravitate towards the 720p resolution, while we may see tablets hitting the 1080p resolution mark, and



some even exceeding it. E-paper display, primarily driven by e-book readers, will become a US \$1.03 billion market this year, and apart from electrophoretic displays, Fujitsu's cholesteric LCD displays with colour might also debut. **d**

Online shopping estimated to cross \$10 billion

Will witness increased consumer confidence

Slow to take-off in the early years of internet, online commerce or e-commerce is rapidly picking up pace in India, and one of the fastest growing sectors of business and investment. By the end of 2011, the overall e-commerce sector was approximately worth around ₹50,000 crore, just shy off the US \$10 billion mark. The #1 e-commerce website in India is IRCTC, and travel constitutes over 80 per cent of total money spent on e-commerce websites.

But online retail destinations are also gaining consumer confidence. Flipkart, for example, processes up to 30,000 orders worth ₹2.5 crore each day, and has its eyes set on hitting the US \$1 billion sales mark by 2015. What's more, after months of speculation, Amazon (the world's largest online retailer) will finally open shop in India. With the coming of Amazon, the Indian

retail e-commerce scene will pull it socks and compete, which only sounds great as far as the consumers are concerned. It's a great time to be an online shopper in 2012, that's for sure. **d**



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